

Workplace Violence Prevention and Reporting

Policy Number	POL-EH-011	Owner / Department	Environmental Health & Safety · Employee Health · Security
Effective Date	2023-11-01	Version	2.2
Last Revised	2026-03-12	Next Review	2028-03-12
Approved By	Environmental Health & Safety Committee	Applies To	All staff, in all areas, including violence from patients, visitors, and coworkers

1. Purpose

To protect staff from workplace violence (WPV) through prevention, de-escalation, response, and consistent reporting, consistent with the OSHA General Duty Clause and OSHA's healthcare WPV guidelines (Publication 3148).

2. Definitions

- **Workplace violence** — any act or threat of physical violence, harassment, intimidation, or threatening behavior occurring at the worksite.
- **Code Gray** — the facility alert for a combative or threatening person requiring a team response.

3. Response and Reporting

1. Ensure personal safety and the safety of others; call a Code Gray and Security for any imminent threat.
2. Use approved de-escalation techniques; restraint is a last resort governed by POL-NUR-005.
3. Obtain medical evaluation for any injured staff through Employee Health or the ED.
4. File an event report per POL-RM-013 for every WPV event, including verbal threats and near misses — non-punitive and expected.

IMPORTANT — An assault causing injury is at least SEV-2. OSHA severe-injury reporting applies to the facility: a work-related fatality is reported to OSHA within 8 hours, and any in-patient hospitalization, amputation, or loss of an eye within 24 hours — coordinated by EH&S.;

4. References

- OSH Act, Section 5(a)(1) — General Duty Clause.
- OSHA Publication 3148 — Guidelines for Preventing Workplace Violence for Healthcare and Social Service Workers.
- OSHA 29 CFR 1904 — recording and reporting of occupational injuries.
- Related: POL-NUR-005, POL-RM-013.